

Attachment to Parasocial Targets and Its Impact on Work Performance: A Quantitative Analysis on Bangladeshi Youth (Aged: 13 - 25 Years)

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Abstract

Parasocial relationships among young people and their devotion to them were observed to have increased in recent times. This had raised concerns from people directly involved in managing the youth about their well-being and future direction. Due to that, this study aimed to figure out the impact of people's attachment levels to parasocial targets to their work performance. A quantitative analysis was conducted through an online survey for assessing participants' attachment levels and work performance. A total of 20 responses were collected from Bangladeshi youth aged 13 to 25 years. The data was analysed through descriptive and correlational analysis via Microsoft Excel and IBM SPSS. Pearson's correlation coefficient (r) of 0.5364 and a statistical significance (p) of 0.015 were found with the data. Therefore, a correlation existed with the variables and the null hypothesis was rejected. The study unravelled that, while both very low and very high attachment levels corresponded with destructive work performance effects, people with higher-than-average attachment levels showed constructive effects in work performance. This indicated that a somewhat high commitment to parasocial targets could possibly correspond to better personal work performance. Research findings from this study can be used to update our perception regarding media fixation of people and for strategic use in our performance optimization.

Keywords: Parasocial Relationships (PSR), Parasocial Targets, Attachment levels, Work Performance.

Introduction

The attraction to famous public figures like actors or singers, and the relatability and admiration for characters in novels or films have always remained with the people throughout different eras. Recently however, this phenomenon has greatly increased with the entertainment industry targeting the very traits which promote audience's fondness in their produced personalities in multiple entertainment sectors such as dramas, movies or music groups for increased profit. Similarly, this can be observed in the writing of comics, novels,